ADVISING HANDBOOK

COE COLLEGE

LEARNING COMMONS

FALL 2024

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STUDENT NOTIFICATION OF RIGHTS UNDER FERPA

The Family Educational Rights and Privacy Act (FERPA) affords students certain rights with respect to their education records.

Family Educational Rights and Privacy Act (FERPA)

The provisions of the Family Educational Rights and Privacy Act (FERPA) protect students from having any part of their academic records, including grades in courses, attendance patterns, and grades on individual assignments, released to anyone (including parents) without their written permission. Further information concerning Coe College procedures in compliance with FERPA is available in the Office of the Registrar, the Coe College Catalog and "FERPA Information" on the faulty tab of my.coe.

Before sharing information with a third party (parent etc.) about a student, you are required to refer to the student's FERPA Release of Information form, which identifies to whom and what information can be released. The instruction for doing so are on "FERPA Information" on the faculty tab of my.coe.

THE ROLE OF ADVISOR

Advisors can log on to my.coe to retrieve class lists, obtain rosters of advisees, view and print advisee schedules and unofficial transcripts (course histories). Prior to the first advising session, advisors should have received a student file with details of the advisee's educational background to assist in the advising process.

Advisor (Faculty) Responsibilities:

- be familiar with graduation requirements and other institutional policies outlined in the Coe College Catalog, including the College's academic policies and procedures
- guide students through the Coe curriculum, including the Academic Core
- be familiar with critical dates on academic calendar
- improve advising skills through regular training
- be available to students at regular times that are known to students
- acquaint students with their academic options at Coe
- acquaint students with relevant academic policies
- refer students to appropriate campus resources as needed (financial aid, registrar, etc.)
- explain impact of registration holds and how to get them lifted
- encourage students to think about the purpose of a college education and to reflect on why and how they are pursuing a college education
- guide students in developing decision-making skills
- encourage students to take responsibility for their choices and the consequences of those choices
- assist students in selecting courses that reflect individual interests and abilities
- guide students in thinking about how their goals can be supported by coursework, including off-campus study, internships, and independent projects
- help students examine their aptitudes, dispositions, skills, and interests, and identify gaps in their skills and knowledge
- help students make connections between disparate areas of study, and between academic, co-curricular, and non-academic areas
- check in with students regularly about their progress through Coe academically, intellectually, socially, and personally
- help students plan a four-year education in a thoughtful, deliberate fashion – re-evaluate plans regularly

ADVISING FIRST-YEAR STUDENTS
(GENERAL ADVISING)

I. Advising Goals regarding first-year students

- Help student understand Coe: people, places, policies
- Check in about how well student is navigating academic, social & co-curricular elements
- Help student reflect on their performance in class (and potentially outside of class): how are they doing, and why? How is college different than high school and different than what they expected?
- Encourage student to think about strengths and weaknesses
- Help student understand the Academic Core, both purpose and requirements
- Orient student toward a four-year picture and when to concentrate on which elements: major, Academic Core, electives – use Academic Core and electives to help undecideds with exploration; use them to help decided to think about areas that might support or complement the major
- Start thinking about off-campus study (application for financial aid for non-exchange programs due December of sophomore year)
- Consider May Term, Wilderness Field Station
- Think about how to make up any credits if student will fall short of 8 at end of year

II. Assisting course selection for First-Year students

- The *Recommended First 2 Year Courses by Major* document identifies recommended courses for students starting majors. It is available in the Advising Toolkit on my.coe.edu.
- The lists of diverse perspective courses as well as mathematics and natural sciences courses appropriate for non-majors are available in the Advising tool-kit on faculty tab of my.coe.edu.
- For majors in Nursing, or Teacher Education, prospective majors must begin course work in the first year or even the first term to be able to complete the program in four years.
- Completion of Teacher Certification in four years, especially for elementary education, requires careful planning. Students interested in earning teacher certification should be advised to arrange a conference with a member of the Teacher Education Department.
- Completion of the Bachelor of Science in Nursing degrees in four years requires careful planning. **Students interested in pursuing a B.S.N. degree are encouraged to consult a faculty member in the nursing department.**

III. First-Year Policies and Opportunities

- First-year students must successfully complete a First-Year Seminar course. Although a student may drop a First-Year Seminar after the Date of Record, or may receive a failing grade, the seminar requirement is not waived. In such a case, a Spring Term course designated by the Registrar as a suitable First-year Seminar course must be taken in the next Spring Term for which the student registers. With the successful completion of this Spring Term seminar course, any student's 'F' grade in the First-year Seminar course will be changed to a 'U' grade.
- Acceptance into the Crimson Fellows program takes place on a rolling basis. The competitive selection is based primarily on a student application essay, the high school transcript, and teacher recommendations.

IV. Important Contact information for First-Year students

- Learning Commons: academic coaches, accessibility services, speaking center, study abroad, tutoring, writing center https://www.coe.edu/academics/coe-difference-centers-and-programs/learning-commons
- Coe Wellness: resources for holistic well-being https://www.coe.edu/student-life/student-life-resources/health-wellness
- Stewart Memorial Library: inter-library loan and research assistance https://www.coe.edu/academics/stewart-memorial-library
- Student Life: chaplain, residence life student organizations https://www.coe.edu/student-life/student-development
- Registrar: questions about AP/IB and transfer credit https://www.coe.edu/academics/academic-resources/registrar

ADVISING PROVISIONALLY ADMITTED STUDENTS

1) How does a student become a provisional admit?

FIRST-YEAR APPLICANTS

Coe is a selective, private, nationally-recognized liberal arts college whose applicants are evaluated through a competitive admission process. The Office of Admission looks at a number of factors including high school academic record, class rank, standardized test scores, and involvement in high school or community activities.

For regular admission, a student's minimum academic profile is expected to be at or above a 3.0 GPA (4 point scale), 20 ACT (1020 combined SAT), and within the top 40% of his or her graduating class. A student's academic transcript should reflect a college preparatory curriculum with sufficient breadth to enable the student's adjustment to a rigorous college liberal arts program. Four years of English; three years of mathematics, science, and history; and two years of foreign language are recommended for all students.

This academic profile is a general guideline, and students who have a lower GPA, standardized test score, or class rank may be requested to provide additional information (seventh term grades, personal statement, personal interview, etc.) for the evaluation process. Coe recognizes that many factors or circumstances may have affected a student's high school performance and students who do not meet our regular admission standards are evaluated more thoroughly by the Admission Committee. Supporting recommendations may be provided by high school guidance counselors, teachers, and administrators. Some students may be accepted on a provisional status upon enrolling at the College. (Catalog Copy)

2) What are the mandated academic supports for the provisionally admitted students?

Students accepted with provisional status must register for one of the following during their first term at Coe:

SKD -115 Summer Bridge (0.3 credit) is a one week course that takes place the week prior to Orientation. Students participate in two mini-classes taught by college faculty. Each mini-class is followed by small group discussions regarding course content, learning strategies, college expectations, etc. Additional workshops are held throughout Summer Bridge on topics such as: financial literacy, campus resources, goal setting and academic planning. Summer Bridge also offers opportunities to make social connections through a variety of informal and planned activities. This program is available to TRIO-eligible students.

SKD-125 Learning Lab (0.5 credit) familiarizes students with the skills and methods of study that lead to competence in college coursework. Through self-assessment and reflection students determine strategies to increase satisfaction and success in the college environment.

SKD-120 Concepts of Individualized Learning (0.0 credit) provides a weekly engagement with an academic coach to identify interests and explore strengths, applying this knowledge to the development of a personal academic plan. Topics include learning strategies, self-regulation,

personal and professional growth, goal setting, campus engagement and self-reflection. (this is a non-credit bearing class)

3) How is the student informed of their "provisionally admitted" status?

The Admission Office sends a Coe College acceptance letter to the provisionally admitted student with a welcome to Coe College and a notice that the student is being admitted provisionally. The subsequent expectations and a brief explanation of the mandatory academic supports are included in the letter.

4) What is the process of linking the students to the mandatory supports?

Students who have submitted an admission deposit are permitted to register for fall term classes during Admitted Student Weekend or the new student summer registration process. Designated faculty advisors meet with the provisionally admitted students to select and register for classes. Immediately following, the students will meet with a member of the TRIO/Academic Achievement Program or Learning Commons staff to discuss the academic support options in more detail. The student is expected to make their selection known at that time.

5) What happens at the end of the term?

A provisionally admitted student must successfully complete one of these three choices and maintain a GPA above the college's Minimum GPA Levels (see Coe Catalog) to have their provisional status removed. Failure to do so in the first semester of enrollment will subject students to academic probation for the second term.

6) What is the Advisor's role in the process?

- Make sure the student is registered for one of the three academic supports.
- Review the student's course selections to determine if appropriate choices have been made based on academic background, competing time commitments, academic demands of intended schedule, etc.
- Communicate any concerns that develop during the term with the appropriate resources including the Learning Commons, Student Development, Health Services and Financial Aid.
- Check in frequently with the student on an individual basis to monitor academic progress and offer support.

ADVISING SECOND-YEAR STUDENTS

Second-year students are vulnerable to the woes of the "sophomore slump." The excitement of embarking on a new adventure in college may have worn off. The close attention they received in their First-Year Seminar is over. Some may be leaving a first-year advisor and building relationships with a new advisor. Sophomores may feel increased pressure to move from broad exploration of field of study to settling on their major(s). Some students may confront the unsettling realization that they must/get to change their paths and identify a different major. During this transition from newbies to advanced students, sophomores may lose traction on their paths toward graduation. Research indicates that major factors encouraging thriving in the sophomore year are: (a) being involved in campus activities, (b) having meaningful interaction with faculty members, (c) addressing spirituality needs, and (d) enjoying a strong sense of community. Therefore, be alert to the new challenges facing your sophomore advisees, suggest ways to strengthen ties to the Coe community, and guide them toward resources that will help them identify their academic goals and map out steps to reach them.

I. Basic Guidelines

Every advising session should include:
• Questions that prompt student to reflect on performance, progress, and problem areas
• Inquiry into how well the student is adjusting and attaching to life at Coe
• Brief review of the previous and/or current semester

Every advisor should have:
• Basic understanding of the outlines of each major (particularly when advising outside one's own major)
• High comfort level flipping through catalog in front of student
• High comfort level about calling colleagues in other departments and Registrar's Office
• Good system for keeping track of notes about student and advising sessions

II. Advising Goals in the Second Year

• Help student think about shape of his/her Coe career and develop aspirations including those that are co-curricular. At this point, having acclimated, what does the student want to get out of college?
• Help student think about strengths and weaknesses.
• Consider whether to do off-campus study.
The fall of the sophomore year is the very best time to talk to Dr. Chaimov about study abroad options.
• Choose a major by the end of the sophomore year. Most students benefit from having an advisor in her or his major field as soon as it is identified.
• Start investigating academic practicum options.
• Encourage student to become familiar with offerings of Center for Careers and Creativity and the Learning Commons.

III. Assisting course selection for Second-Year students

The *Recommended First 2 Year Courses by Major* document identifies recommended courses for students starting majors. It is available in the Advising Toolkit on my.coe.edu.
The lists of diverse perspective courses as well as mathematics and natural sciences courses appropriate for non-majors are available in the Advising tool-kit on faculty tab of my.coe.edu.

IV. Important Contact information for sophomores

Learning Commons: academic coaches, accessibility services, speaking center, study abroad, tutoring, writing center https://www.coe.edu/academics/coe-difference-centers-and-programs/learning-commons

Coe Wellness: resources for holistic well-being https://www.coe.edu/student-life/student-life-resources/health-wellness

Stewart Memorial Library: inter-library loan and research assistance
https://www.coe.edu/academics/stewart-memorial-library

Student Development: chaplain, residence life student organizations
https://www.coe.edu/student-life/student-development

Registrar: questions about AP/IB and transfer credit https://www.coe.edu/academics/academic-resources/registrar

V. Useful events and programs

- Sophomorepalooza: welcome back party
- Pizza and Practicum: meet juniors and seniors to learn about ways of meeting practicum requirement
- Study Abroad fair in mid-September
  - Students who want to participate in an off-campus program not directly administered by Coe (such as and ACM program) need to apply to Coe by the last day of classes of the previous academic year.
  - Students who want to participate in a Coe exchange, you must apply to Coe by the middle of the previous semester.
- Major Declaration Day

ADVISING JUNIORS

(most of your junior advisees will be majoring within your discipline)

I Basic Guidelines

Every advising session should include:

• Questions that prompt student to reflect on performance, progress, and problem areas
• Inquiry into how well the student is developing and examining aspirations
• Brief review of the previous and/or current semester

Every advisor of juniors within her/his major should have:

• Solid understanding of requirements of her or his own major

II. In the fall of junior year, students should complete the application to graduate form.
Log into my.Coe.edu >> student tab >> "My Graduation Info," >> "Grad Application."
The "expected graduation date" form can be found at my.coe, student tab, "My Graduation Info," and select "Grad Application"

III. Advising goals in the third year:

• Research academic practicum options (especially if doing an internship); decide about academic practicum by end of the year.
• Encourage student to start thinking about aspirations for post-graduate life.
• Encourage student to start actively using Center for Creativity and Careers if he or she hasn't already.
• Help student think about courses that will complement and enhance major, career and other life aspirations.

IV. Important Contact information for Juniors

- Learning Commons: academic coaches, accessibility services, speaking center, study abroad, tutoring, writing center https://www.coe.edu/academics/coe-difference-centers-and-programs/learning-commons

- Coe Wellness: resources for holistic well-being https://www.coe.edu/student-life/student-life-resources/health-wellness

- Stewart Memorial Library: inter-library loan and research assistance https://www.coe.edu/academics/stewart-memorial-library

- Student Development: chaplain, residence life student organizations
  https://www.coe.edu/student-life/student-development

- Off-Campus study: semester and year-long opportunities in the US and internationally

https://www.coe.edu/academics/coe-difference-centers-and-programs/off-campus-study

IV. Useful events and dates

- Center for Careers and Creativity's Alumni Mentoring and networking events.
- Study Abroad fair: late September

  Students who want to participate in an off-campus program not directly administered by Coe (such as an ACM program) need to apply to Coe by the last day of classes of the previous academic year.
  Students who want to participate in a Coe exchange must apply to Coe by the middle of the previous semester.
- Application for Student Research Symposium early in spring semester
- Major declaration day

ADVISING JUNIORS: INTENT TO GRADUATE

Who – Juniors (anyone with 16+ credits)

What – **Graduation Application**

When – **Fall** of Junior Year (or as soon as someone has earned 16 credits)

Where – Please have students complete this form during your advising appointment in the Fall of their Junior year. (We know that even students with the best intentions may forget later after your appointment is over).

How – Log into my.Coe.edu >> student tab >> "My Graduation Info," >> "Grad Application.

The "expected graduation date" form can be found at my.coe, student tab, "My Graduation Info," and select "Grad Application."

Why –

- It affirms the student's plan for the next year and a half
- It assists Registrar, Financial Aid, Room Draw, Advancement – by updating the expected graduation date
- Prepares students for the degree audit process

ADVISING SENIORS

(most of your senior advisees will be majoring within your discipline)

I. Basic Guidelines

Every advising session should include:

• Questions that prompt student to reflect on performance, progress, and problem areas

• Inquiry into how well the student is developing and examining aspirations

• Brief review of the previous and/or current semester

Every advisor of juniors within her/his major should have:

• Solid understanding of requirements of her or his own major

II. Advising Goals for the fourth year:

- Make certain advisees have submitted their intent to graduate form
  - The "expected graduation date" form can be found at my.coe, student tab, "My Graduation Info," and select "Grad Application."

• Encourage student to make full use of Center for Creativity and Careers

• Help student think about courses that will support career and other post-graduate aspirations; use electives to round out college education

• Help student think concretely and imaginatively about post-graduate life

III. Useful events and dates

- Center for Careers and Creativity's Alumni Mentoring and networking events.
- Application deadline for Student Research Symposium is early in spring semester
- Honors thesis dates. When a completed thesis is approved by an Honors Examining Committee, an electronic copy and two paper copies must be submitted to the Director of the Stewart Memorial Library no later than 4:00 of Reading Day of Spring Term. After submission of the thesis or artifact to the Director of the Stewart Memorial Library, the student must turn in the Certification of Satisfactory Completion of the Honors Thesis, signed by the Honors Examining Committee members and the Director of the Stewart Memorial Library to the Office of the Registrar, no later than 4:00 p.m. of Reading Day

ADVISING TRANSFER STUDENTS

Transfer students are defined as anyone who matriculates at Coe who has studied for at least one term at another degree-seeking institution. They bring a wide variety of perspectives and experiences to campus, and usually need to be advised by someone in their intended field of study immediately.

Some things to keep in mind as you work with transfer students:

- Beginning Fall 2024, all transfer students **must** enroll in **SKD 150: Transfer Advisory** (0.2cc) in addition to their other courses.
- There is a sliding scale of required WE and DAC courses based on the number of credits students transfer in to Coe. Please refer to the Coe College Catalog for details.
- Transfer students who come in with an Associate's Degree *do not have to complete any additional Academic Core requirements, WE or DAC courses.*
- All transfer students must complete a practicum requirement.

Transfer students are normally trying to complete their degree at Coe in a limited number of semesters, and thus it is exceptionally important to help them keep track of their requirements and progress towards graduation. Please make sure that transfer students know that it is their responsibility to have official transcripts from their previous institutions sent over to the Registrar's office. If they are planning to graduate within the next 3-4 semesters, they need to fill out the "Intent to Graduate" form on my.coe as soon as possible to trigger academic audits.

ADVISING INTERNATIONAL STUDENTS

As a faculty advisor, you will at some point advise international students who bring diverse cultures, perspectives, and goals to the advising conversation. Because of US government regulations, most international students also have special academically related considerations, even constraints. Although you typically will not know an advisee's immigration status, many of our students have the same classification, thus we're providing information below that should be generally helpful in your role as advisor. Please refer students to International Student Affairs (ISA) for regulatory advising.

Most of our non-immigrant students hold F-1[1] visa status and are subject to reporting through SEVIS.[2] The following issues will impact academic decisions F-1 students make:

1. **A student's declared major will impact employment options after graduation**, if the student elects to stay in the US. For example, pre and post-completion employment options for F-1 students are limited to work directly related to the student's major. In addition, students with STEM majors can benefit from access to longer post-completion employment benefits (24 additional months, subject to specific conditions). A student's major field of study, depending on their home country and US relations with that nation, can also impact visa renewal.
2. **F-1 students must maintain full-time enrollment** (a minimum of 3 courses) with limited exceptions. Any drop below a full course load must be documented and approved by the DIA (and entered into SEVIS) prior to the reduction of courses. If an international student wants to drop below 3 courses, please refer the student to me BEFORE signing the drop form. A blatant error would be for the international student to not even register as a full-time student at the beginning of the semester. (*Note: Potential exceptions include: academic / linguistic difficulties in the first term; mis-advising; documented medical conditions; or if fewer courses are needed during the final academic term.*)
3. **International students are not required to attend classes during the summer session.** During this time they are free to rest, travel, return home, or study full- or part-time.
4. **F-1 students must make "normal progress" toward degree completion**. A program extension requires regulatory approval, processed through ISA.
5. **F-1 students may typically participate in off-campus study or internships abroad**. There may be unique visa and employment issues to consider, so advanced planning is very important. Off-campus employment is prohibited during an international student's first 9 months (typically a full school year) in F-1 status.
6. **F-1 students may hold an on-campus job,** working up to 20 hours per week during the school year. They may work "full time" on campus during breaks or over the summer. They may not hold a student employment position during the summer following their commencement. *(Note: Though not at Coe, there are some international students, holding other visa classifications, who are not allowed campus employment.)*
7. **F-1 students may not accept employment (internships or research) that results in payment (wages, stipends, fellowships, housing, etc.) from a source other than Coe College, without first securing employment authorization.** The primary options are Curricular Practical Training (CPT)[3] or Optional Practical Training (OPT)[4]. Both options

require that the employment be "directly related to the student's major area." Students must consult with ISA well in advance of needing employment authorization. Summer internships that are funded entirely through Coe College are ideal for our F-1 students, since the stipends for most of these educational experiences comes solely from the College and SEVIS employment authorization will not usually be required. Unpaid experiences (with no wage, stipend, housing, etc.) may not require SEVIS employment authorization; however, the work site may have a different interpretation of this scenario. Working closely with the ISA is advised.

8. **All F-1 students are required to file a federal tax return**, even if they don't have taxable income. The DIA provides basic support (or referral) for students to comply with this immigration regulation.
9. **Criminal arrests, even misdemeanor charges, can have very serious consequences for non-immigrant visitors.** The ISA can advise students on these matters, or can refer them for consultation with area attorneys who specialize in immigration and/or criminal law.
10. **When they are seniors, F-1 students receive guidance from the DIA about their next steps through individual appointments.** They typically have the following options: 1) "transfer" their SEVIS record to a graduate program in the US; 2) apply for employment authorization through Post-Completion Optional Practical Training (OPT); or 3) leave the US within an authorized grace period (60 days). F-1 students who remain in the US for OPT or for the 24-month STEM Extension maintain F-1 status and are required to report through ISA during the post-completion employment period. I can provide handouts on these options, tips on presenting their status during employment interviews, basic information about the H-1B petition.

If you receive related questions from students, please refer them to International Student Affairs.

Terms and Definitions:

F-1: A nonimmigrant temporarily in the U.S. to study full-time at an academic or language institute.

SEVIS (Student and Exchange Visitor Information System): A web-based system used to provide real-time, up-to-date information on F, M, and J nonimmigrants managed by the Student and Exchange Visitor Program (SEVP) within the Department of Homeland Security (DHS).

Curricular Practical Training (CPT): Alternative work/study, internship, cooperative education, or any other type of required internship or practicum that is offered by sponsoring employers through cooperative agreements with a school. It is only available to students when it is an integral part of an establish curriculum.

Optional Practical Training (OPT): Another type of practical training available to nonimmigrant students, which differs from CPT in that 1) it is not an integral part of a student's academic program and 2) it requires DHS adjudication. It is available to students while completing their program of study or upon completion of it.

ADVISING STUDENTS ON ACADEMIC PROBATION

1. How is Academic Probation Determined?

ACADEMIC PROBATION

The Academic Standing Committee reviews academic records of all students at the conclusion of both the Fall and Spring Terms. A student is placed on academic probation if the cumulative GPA falls below the minimum GPA levels listed below:

Total Course Credits Attempted	Minimum GPA Levels
0.0 – 4.99	l.50
5.0 – 7.9	l.75
8.0 – 11.9	1.80
12.0 – 15.9	1.90
16.0+	2.00

Students who are placed on probation for academic standing reasons will receive a letter via their Coe email address notifying them of their probation status. To return to good standing and be removed from academic probation, a student shall earn a cumulative GPA greater than the threshold for academic probation as specified above. If the student's cumulative GPA decreases at the end of any term on probation, the student is subject to academic suspension. Students who are placed on academic probation have a maximum of two (2) consecutive terms, excluding May and Summer, to return to good standing before they are subject to academic suspension.

Students who are on academic probation:

- Are expected to comply with any requirements outlined by the Academic Standing Committee.
- May not elect P/NP grading in lieu of a letter grade.
- May not be excused from attending class to participate in extra-curricular activities.

2. How is the student and advisor alerted to the probationary status and what are the follow-up expectations?

Students placed or continued on probation receive a letter from the Registrar at the end of each term. The student's Academic Advisor also receives a copy of this letter by email. **Students on probation are required to enroll in SKD 145: Strategies for Academic Success.** In addition, students may be required to meet with other appropriate college officials.

3. What can the Advisor do for a student with academic difficulties?

Monitor academic progress before the beginning of each term

You should review academic progress before or at the beginning of each term to identify students who are struggling. Viewing a student academic transcript is often a good way to see

trends within a student's academic progress. Know the GPA requirements for good academic standing in your program. In addition to students who fall below good standing, make note of students whose grades are uncharacteristically below their usual performance or have failed a single course. Performance at this level, which clearly indicates a problem, may not be cause for an alert from the Registrar and will possibly only be noticed by you. For some students, meeting with you may be the opportunity to get the timely support they need to face the academic challenges contributing to poor academic performance.

Steps for advising students who are struggling or on academic probation

1) Before or within the first week of classes review current course schedule and make changes if needed. Be sure the student is registered for an appropriate number of course credits. Check to see that courses are taken in the appropriate sequence, prerequisites are being met and that general education requirements are being completed. Schedule course combinations that might ease some pressure. When possible, schedule classes with the goal in mind of getting the highest grades possible to raise the GPA.

   PLEASE NOTE: Students are often required to meet with their advisor as a condition of their probation to reconsider their academic schedule.

2) Explain the expectations and consequences of academic probation using the Catalog as a reference and show the student where to find this information. Review the letter received by the student explaining the terms of the academic probation. Within a few weeks, follow-up with the student to make sure the conditions of probation have been addressed.

3) Discuss strategies for improvement. No matter how the discussion evolves, students should be encouraged to talk about their sense of what the difficulties are and what steps they are taking to improve their performance. Support students in evaluating their situation honestly and making their own decisions. Following are common academic factors to explore with the student that may have contributed to failure:

- ☐ Difficult classes/not prepared for course level
- ☐ Registered for too many classes
- ☐ Lack of utilizing professors' office hours
- ☐ Unable to understand course content/relevance
- ☐ Overall schedule too rigorous (school, athletics, work, etc.)
- ☐ Ineffective study skills
- ☐ Did not attend class
- ☐ Over-involved with extra-curricular activities
- ☐ Working too much
- ☐ Undeveloped time management skills
- ☐ Unprepared for exams
- ☐ Difficulty with early morning classes
- ☐ If you know or suspect that your advisee has a learning disability but is not utilizing appropriate academic accommodations, consider contacting the

Accessibility Services Coordinator. Do not initiate this conversation with the student.

4) Revisit choice of major. If the courses that caused a student a problem were courses in their major area, it might be the time to revisit their academic goals. Doing poorly in an entry-level major course may indicate that they need to explore other options. Encourage students to speak to faculty in other majors. Students should also be encouraged to visit the Center for Creativity and Careers to discuss other possible career paths and academic majors

5) Initiate referrals where additional support is indicated such as the Learning Commons, Writing Center, tutoring, supplemental instruction (sciences) departmental help sessions, etc. Check in with the student a couple of weeks into the term to see how they are doing, keeping in mind the last day to withdraw from a class with a W.

6) Advising first-generation college students may require some additional thought and consideration. As the first in their family to attend college, first-generation students typically lack the traditional support networks available to their peers whose parents earned degrees (Pascarella, Pierson, Wolniak & Terenzina, 2004). Compounding lack of information from familial role models, first-generation students may not possess the necessary knowledge and skills to negotiate the complex bureaucracy of an academic institution, manage conflicting family expectations and balance the competing commitments of school and work (Kaufman, Alt and Chapman, 2004). Some agree that the number of advisor-advisee meetings may positively influence rates of persistence and academic standing (Ishitani, 2006, Tinto, 1997) Some agree that the number of advisor-advisee meetings may positively influence rates of persistence and academic standing (Ishitani, 2006, Tinto, 1997). First-generation students are often less likely to utilize office hours or seek help, so advisor outreach is important.

GPA Calculator

Academic Standing is based on cumulative GPA and therefore it is often difficult to predict the impact of a single term on a cumulative GPA. There is a GPA calculator available on *my.coe.edu* student tab that can help predict GPA changes, including credits and grades needed to reach certain benchmarks (or the potential impact of future terms).

Ways to Increase GPA

Grade Replacement – this policy provides a way for students to quickly remove poor grades from their GPA calculation. Re-taking the same class at Coe, and receiving a higher grade on the repeated attempt, will remove the original grade from the GPA calculation and use the new grade instead. If a student re-takes an equivalent course at another institution and transfers it to Coe, the previous poor grade is removed, but the new transfer grade is not calculated into the GPA. No additional course credit is earned for the Course Repeat Option unless the student initially failed the class. For the official grade replacement policy, review the Coe Catalog

Warning – Students who have failed or withdrawn from numerous classes, should be cautious about grade replacement. See section below about the intersection of academic standing with financial aid. Repeating courses works against a student's attempted versus completed course percentage.

Financial Aid and Academic Difficulties

Financial Aid and academic standing are closely tied, but there are some distinctions that are important to understand.

The most important policy related to financial aid and students who are struggling academically is Satisfactory Academic Progress (SAP). This is the process by which the Federal Government ensures that students are making progress towards a degree while receiving federal financial aid. It both protects the student from taking out excessive aid, such as loans, when they are not making progress and also protects the aid system from abuse of students who are overusing aid.

For more information, refer to the *Federal and State Eligibility Requirements: Satisfactory Academic Progress Policy* section of the **Financial Aid Handbook**, located on the Coe Financial Aid webpage OR contact the Financial Aid Office.

SPAN Alert

Whenever a student is earning less than a satisfactory grade in a course, the instructor is encouraged to submit a SPAN Alert. The Academic Advisor should reach out via email or phone to these students so that they may discuss their low academic performance. Students are often grateful for the extra support and any potential referrals to support services.

Exiting the College

A student who is struggling academically may sometimes consider a leave of absence or withdrawal from the college. In such case, refer the student to the Associate Dean of Student Academics, located in the Learning Commons, for assistance.

(Sources: Ishitani, T. T. (2006). Studying attrition and degree completion behavior among first-generation college students in the United States. *The Journal of Higher Education*, 77(5), 861–885; Kaufman, P., Alt, M. N., & Chapman, C. (2004). Dropout rates in the United States: 2001 (NCES 2005-046). Washington, DC: U.S. Department of Education, National Center for Education Statistics; Pascarella, E., Pierson, C., Wolniak, G., & Terenzini, P. (2004). First-generation college students: Additional evidence on college experiences and outcomes. *The Journal of Higher Education*, 75(3), 249–284; Tinto, V. (1997). Colleges as communities: Exploring the education character of student persistence. *Journal of Higher Education*, 68(6), 599–623.)

BASIC COMPARISONS BETWEEN TWO TYPES OF OFF-CAMPUS PROGRAMS

(CHEAT-SHEET FOR ADVISORS)

Coe-administered Programs **(Exchanges in Ghana, Sweden, Thailand, etc.)**	**Programs not administered by Coe** **(SIT, Euroscholars, IES, etc.)**
100% of Coe gift aid transfers automatically	Committee decides what % of aid may transfer
Make friends with incoming students before you go	More support, often an American faculty advisor on site
Generally housing in student apartments	Often housing in homestays
Best for outgoing problem-solvers	Apply to Coe last day of classes of fall term, year before you go
Apply to Coe mid-semester before you go, in most cases	

Scholarships: Gilman (Pell Grant), Phi Kappa Phi (high GPA),

John Chaimov, Director of Off-Campus Study, Learning Commons, 319 399-8594 or 319 399-8062, jchaimov@coe.edu

OPTIONS FOR MAKING UP COURSE CREDIT

To graduate in 8 semesters, Coe students must earn an average of 4 credits each semester. What can students do if they do not earn 4 credits any semester and need to make up credits?

1) Students can take more classes during subsequent semesters
    a) Students can take partial credit courses to earn over and above 4 credits. *Note: no more than a total of two course credits from courses that are less than .5 credit can be used to meet then 32-credit graduation requirement.*
        i) PE activity courses (0.2 credit each)
        ii) MUA ensembles -- most require auditions (0.2 to 0.5 credit each)
        iii) MUA music lessons (0.3 credit lessons cost $230)
        iv) Theatre production lab (0.25 credit) and Theatre practicum (0.5 credit)
        v) Dance classes (DAN 0.2 credit)
        vi) SKD courses
        vii) HSS or CFP courses

    b) Strong students could petition to take more than 4.9 credits. This is not recommended for First-Year students.

2) Students can take courses in the summer
    a) May term courses 1 full credit
        i) Students must pay the course fees for any and all May term course they take.
        ii) For the first May term course taken, the student will not have to pay an additional tuition fee. For subsequent May term courses, the student will be charged $625 for tuition.
        iii) All May term courses now satisfy Coe's practicum requirement

    b) Wilderness Field Station courses (1 full credit)
        i) http://www.coe.edu/academics/fieldstation
        ii) Any course taken at the field station satisfies Coe's practicum requirement
        iii) Costs (2017 example $3,570 Covers tuition, room and board)
        iv) Some courses meet Coe's non-lab or lab natural science requirement
    c) Summer credit-bearing internship (there will be a cost)
    d) Summer on-line courses ($1500)
    e) Summer research (by invitation only)

f) Transfer in credits

i) This information can be found in the Coe College Catalog

(1) The Registrar's office must approve of a transfer credit in advance. Departments must approve in advance any courses counting toward a major, a minor, or teacher certification requirements.

(2) Coe accepts a course in transfer for the equivalent earned credit (4 semester hours – 1 course credit), if that course meets the spirit of the College's mission and is from a regionally accredited institution.

(3) Credit will only be awarded for courses earning a grade "C" or above (2.0 on a 4.0 scale).

(4) Students with junior or above standing (at or above 16 course credits) can only transfer in courses taken at 4-year accredited institutions. Students below the junior level (less than 16 course credits) may transfer in credits from 2-year or 4-year institutions.

ii) The Transfer Study Approval Form can be found on Registrar Office Information link on my.coe.

WHETHER (OR NOT) TO WITHDRAW FROM A CLASS

Keep Calm and practice mindful advising. Remember that advising goes well beyond helping students select courses. We serve as advisors to students other than our advisees in our roles as instructors. Our primary goal is to assist the student in making well-informed decisions. The student's best interest should be at the forefront of our efforts to provide the best possible guidance and support that we can offer.

By mid-term some students in your classes or some of your advisees may begin to panic after receiving a low test score or paper grade. Rather than automatically signing off on a drop form, take time to work with the student to address the following questions:

1) Has the student had a conversation with the instructor about their progress in the course?

2) How many grades, tests, papers, projects, etc. are yet to be factored into the final grade?

3) Has the student taken measures to improve academic performance such as:

> a) lined up a tutor b) formed a study group c) studied more often and more effectively d) addressed issues of time management e) regularly attended class

4) Will withdrawing from the class have an impact on the student's financial aid eligibility, their status as a full-time student, their ability to participate in sports activities, etc.?

5) Is this a course required for the major and, if so, when is it offered again? Is it a pre-requisite for another course needed to graduate?

6) Is there an option to take this course elsewhere, perhaps during the summer, and have the credit transferred to Coe?

7) If the student withdraws from the class, what options are there for making up the credit to get back on track for graduation?

8) Can the student take the class P/NP?

9) Is the best strategy to stay in the class and do as well as possible with the idea that the course can be repeated? If necessary, this strategy provides for an opportunity to improve the grade and remove the weaker grade and thereby improve the overall GPA. Students may not realize that they can repeat a course.

9) Will dropping the course help in any way to improve performance in other courses?

10) Are there factors other than academic performance that are hindering the student such as depression, over commitment, need for accommodations etc.? If so, does the student have all the support they need in place?

THE COE PLAN REQUIREMENTS

(Refer to the Coe College Catalog for complete details.)

I. First-Year Experience

For students starting their college education at Coe, the first-year experience includes:

A. Fall orientation activities

B. First-year seminar

C. Writing Portfolio

II. Major

III. Writing Emphasis and Diversity Across the Curriculum Courses

All students earning a B.A. or B.S.N. at Coe College are required to complete 5 courses marked WE with a grade of C or above, and 3 DAC courses (one Global Perspectives, one US Pluralism, and one elective from either category).

IV. Academic Core

All students earning a B.A. or B.S.N. at Coe College are required to complete eleven (11) distribution courses.

- Two courses in Humanistic Inquiry familiarize students with literary, philosophical and religious frameworks for interpreting human experience and how that experience is shaped by its cultural and historical contexts.
- One course in Literary, Artistic and Media Analysis develops students' ability to appreciate literary and artistic forms and their ability to interpret and evaluate literary works, artistic productions, and/or other forms of media.
- One course in Artistic Creation engages students in the act of creation while developing their understanding of and fluency within creative artistic forms.
- One course in Quantitative and Formal Reasoning develops students' ability to reason using numerical, logical, and other symbolic systems, and enhances their ability to extract information from real-world data.
- Two courses in Natural Science Inquiry lead students to investigate the natural world through scientific practices that include observation, experimentation, and analysis. At least one of these courses must be identified as "Experimental Learning."
- Two courses in Social and Behavioral Analysis advance an understanding of social, economic, and political systems and of human behavior and its causes.
- One course in Diversity, Equity and Inclusion invites students to explore the nature of social identities in the context of social structures and social change and to critically examine and reflect on issues of power, privilege, discrimination, equity, and inclusivity.
- One course in Cross-Cultural Communication and Engagement develops effective linguistic and/or intercultural skills through engagement and reflection.

V. Academic Practicum

VI. At least **32 earned credits** with grades leading to a cumulative GPA of 2.0 or higher